VICTORY 2026

HISTORY

Independence & Partition of India

Lecture 01

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Topics *to be covered*

1 Cabinet Missim Plan

Events that Led to the Cabinet Mission



ICSE Syllabus

(c) Independence and Partition of India – *Cabinet Mission Plan (clauses only); Mountbatten Plan (clauses and its acceptance); and the Indian Independence Act of 1947 (clauses only).*


JURASSIC WORLD
SE LIVE
Physics Wallah
T-REX SIR



Ques

Which of the following was formed by Netaji?

(a) Indian Association
(b) Indian National Conference
(c) Indian League
(d) Forward Bloc



Independence and Partition Of India

1. India's freedom struggle entered a new phase by the end of the Second World War.

2. This period was extremely uneasy and difficult because the Indian National Army (INA) had met an unfortunate end, memories of Quit India Movement were still fresh and the Muslim League was demanding for the creation of a separate state of Pakistan.

3. Lord Wavell announced the 'Wavell Plan' which included granting dominion status to India and the provision of drafting the Constitution of India by the Indians.



EVENTS THAT LED TO THE CABINET MISSION

1. CHANGES IN BRITAIN

(i) The World War changed the balance of power in the world. The United States of America and the Soviet Union, became two big powers after WWII. Both supported India's demand for freedom.

(ii) Even though Britain was on the winning side of the War, its economic and military power became weak . It would take Britain years to recover



EVENTS THAT LED TO THE CABINET MISSION

(iii) There was a change of government in Britain. The Conservatives were replaced by the Labour Party, many of them supported the Congress demands.

(iv) The British soldiers were tired of the War. Having fought and shed their blood for six years, they had no desire to spend many more years away from home suppressing the Indian people's struggle for freedom.



EVENTS THAT LED TO THE CABINET MISSION

2. REVOLTS IN THE ADMINISTRATIVE AGENCIES

(i) The Government could not any longer rely on Indians for its civil administration or on the armed forces for suppression of the National Movement. The INA had shown that patriotic ideas had entered the ranks of the Indian army, the main component of British rule in India.



EVENTS THAT LED TO THE CABINET MISSION

(ii) There was a revolt of the Indian Naval ratings at Mumbai in February 1946. The ratings had fought a seven-hour battle with the army as well as navy and had surrendered only when asked to do so by the national leaders. Naval ratings in many other parts of the country had gone on sympathetic strikes.



EVENTS THAT LED TO THE CABINET MISSION

(iii) There were also widespread strikes in the Royal Indian Air Force. The Indian signal corps at Jabalpur also went on strike.

(iv) The other two major instruments of British rule, the Police and the Civil Service, were showing signs that they could no longer be safely used to suppress the National Movement. For example, the police force in Bihar and Delhi went on strike.



EVENTS THAT LED TO THE CABINET MISSION

3. MOOD OF THE INDIAN PEOPLE

The Indians were in a confident and determined mood. They would no longer tolerate the humiliation (→ insult) of foreign rule. They would not rest till freedom was won. In addition to the revolt of Naval ratings and the struggle for the release of INA prisoners, in 1945-46 there were numerous agitations, strikes, hartals and demonstrations all over the country, even in many Princely States such as Hyderabad, Travancore and Kashmir.



EVENTS THAT LED TO THE CABINET MISSION

4. LABOUR UNREST

There was large-scale labour unrest all over the country.

(i) In July 1946, there was an all-India strike by the postal and telegraph workers.

(ii) Railway workers in South India went on strike in August 1946.

(iii) Peasant movements acquired a fresh thrust after 1945.

↳ new force

Support



EVENTS THAT LED TO THE CABINET MISSION

(iv) The most militant of the post War struggles was the Tebhaga struggle by the share croppers of Bengal who declared that they would pay not one-half but one-third of the crop to the landlords.

(v) Struggles for land and against high rents took place in Hyderabad, Malabar, Bengal, U.P., Bihar and Maharashtra



CABINET MISSION IN INDIA

- Clement Attlee, the new British Prime Minister, declared in the House of Commons on February 19, 1946, that a Cabinet Mission would be sent to India to facilitate the process of transfer of power.
- The Mission's aim would also be to help the Indian leaders decide the form of government that would suit them after the transfer of power.

Why was the Cabinet Mission sent to India in 1946?

1. To facilitate transfer of power to Indians
2. To facilitate the Partition of the country
3. To facilitate the division of resources between Provinces and Princely States.
4. To facilitate the drawing up of the Constitution for each Dominion.



CABINET MISSION IN INDIA

The Cabinet Mission arrived in India in 1946. It consisted of three cabinet members:

(i) Pethic Lawrence, the Secretary of State;

(ii) Sir Stafford Cripps, President of the Board of Trade; and

(iii) A.V. Alexander, the First Lord of Admiralty.

They held discussions with various Indian leaders representing all sections and parties.



CLAUSES OF THE CABINET MISSION PLAN

↳ Points / Suggestions

The Cabinet Mission proposed a two-tier federal plan which was expected to maintain national unity while conceding the largest measure of regional autonomy.

↳ power

Two-tier federal ✓

↓

Two levels of govt



CLAUSES OF THE CABINET MISSION PLAN

1. **Federal Union:** There was to be a federal union of the British Provinces and the princely States. The Union Government (Central Government) should deal with the following subjects: (i) Foreign Affairs; (ii) Defence; and (iii) Communication. The Union Government should have the power to raise the finances required for the above mentioned subjects.



CLAUSES OF THE CABINET MISSION PLAN

2. **Powers of the Union:** The Union would have its own executive and legislature composed of members elected by all Provinces.
3. **Provincial Autonomy:** The Provinces would enjoy full autonomy for all subjects other than the Union Subjects.
4. **Grouping of Provinces**: The British Provinces would be divided into groups. Each group could determine the provincial subjects to be taken in common.

Group A

→ 6 Hindu majority provinces.

→ Madras
→ Bombay
→ Central Provinces
→ United Provinces
→ Bihar and Orissa (Odisha)

Group B

→ 3 Muslim Majority provinces

→ Punjab
→ Sind
→ North West Frontier Province

Group C

→ Bengal

→ Assam

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* Chief-Commissioner's Prov.

→ Delhi, Ajmer-Marwar, Coorg joined Group A

→ Baluchistan → joined Group B

→ A province can leave one group and join another → but for this it required majority of votes.



CLAUSES OF THE CABINET MISSION PLAN

5. **Formation of a Constituent Assembly**: A Constituent Assembly would be set up to frame the new Constitution of the Indian Union. The composition of the 389 member Constituent Assembly would be as under:

(i) 296 members to be elected from the British Provinces.

(ii) 93 members to be elected from the Princely States.

The members of the Constituent Assembly would be elected by the Provincial Legislative Assemblies. Adult suffrage (all eligible voters voting) for this was ruled out to avoid delay in the making of the Constitution.



CLAUSES OF THE CABINET MISSION PLAN

6. **Representation of Minorities:** Separate representation was to be given to Muslims and Sikhs.

7. **Formation of an Interim Government:** An Interim Government would be formed at the Centre with 14 members. For the time being, the Viceroy would reconstitute his Executive Council consisting of representatives of all communities.

8. **Freedom to Join the Commonwealth:** India would be free to remain within the British Commonwealth or secede from it.



CLAUSES OF THE CABINET MISSION PLAN

9. **Transfer of Power:** It would be necessary to work out a Treaty between the Constituent Assembly and the United Kingdom for matters arising out of the transfer of power.

Why did the Muslim League accept the Cabinet Mission Plan?

1. Its demand for a separate nation was fulfilled.
2. It felt that grouping of Muslim majority Provinces was a step towards a separate dominion.
3. It felt that its claim to nominate Muslim members to the Executive Council was supported.
4. None of the above.



REJECTION OF THE DEMAND FOR PAKISTAN

Muslim League's demand for Pakistan was rejected by the Cabinet Mission for the following reasons:

(i) The establishment of Pakistan would not solve the problem of communal minorities because the number of Muslims in the remaining part of British India and the number of non-Muslims in Pakistan would be sizeable.



REJECTION OF THE DEMAND FOR PAKISTAN

(ii) There was no justification for including within Pakistan, the non-Muslim districts of Bengal, Assam and the Punjab.

(iii) The armed forces, transportation as well as the postal and telegraph system had been built for India as a whole and the partition would create many problems.

(iv) The Princely States would find it difficult to decide which Union to join.

(v) The two halves of the proposed Pakistan State would be separated by some seven hundred miles and interaction between them would be difficult.

Arrange the following events in chronological order

(i) End of World War

(ii) Attlee's Announcement

(iii) Mountbatten Plan

(iv) Cabinet Mission

1. (i), (ii), (iii) and (iv)
2. (i), (iv), (ii), and (iii)
3. (i), (iv), (iii) and (ii)
4. (i), (iii), (ii) and (iv)

Ques

According to Cabinet Mission Plan, Group A consisted

(a) 4 Hindu majority provinces

(b) 3 Muslim majority Provinces

(c) 6 Muslim majority Provinces

(d) 6 Hindu Majority Provinces



Homework From VICTORY Module

↳ Revise for Test.


Thank You